NorthWest Student Exchange
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U.S.A. EXCHANGE PROGRAM INFORMATION School Year 2026–2027

Eligibility requirements for applicants:

- Between the ages of 15 and 18½ at the beginning of the exchange
- Currently enrolled in high school in your home country
- Maturity, excellent character, good school record, high motivation, and strong English skills
- NWSE's approval of your application

What is included in my exchange program costs?

- Room and board with a carefully selected and screened volunteer host family
- Supervision by a local NWSE representative
- Enrollment in a public high school (private high schools are also available for additional tuition fees)
- Pre-departure and post-arrival orientations
- Host family orientation
- J-1 Visa Certificate of Eligibility (Form DS-2019)
- Certificate of participation from NWSE (after successful completion of program and submission of evaluation)

What is not included?

- Flights, passport fees, SEVIS fee (Form I-901), visa application fees, and other travel expenses
- English language test fees (ITEP, ELTiS)
- School supplies, school registration and activity fees, sports participation fees
- School lunch fees, if you decide not to pack a lunch from your host family home
- Spending money for your personal expenses (recommended: $250 per month)

When does the exchange program begin?

For fall-semester and academic-year exchanges, most schools begin between mid-August and mid-September; spring semester begins between mid-January and mid-February. Exchange students usually arrive 7-10 days before the first day of school.

What will I study in the U.S.?

In addition to the core subjects (English, math, science, and social studies), you will be able to choose from a wide range of elective subjects. Your school counselor will help you choose appropriate classes based on your age, grade level, education history, and interests. NWSE does not guarantee sports participation, graduation, or a diploma to any student, as these decisions will be made exclusively by your high school.

Program Fees (includes $750 nonrefundable application fee - fees are subject to change)	**Semester**	**Year**
One-Way Exchange (NWSE finds a host family for you)	$8,495	$9,295
Direct Placement (you nominate a host family)	$7,595	$8,395
Reciprocal Exchange (your family also hosts an American student)	$7,495	$8,295

Travel Health Insurance (optional - fees are subject to change)	**Semester**	**Year**
Comfort Plan (travel health insurance and personal liability insurance)	$525	$800
Elite Plan (travel health insurance and personal liability insurance)	$750	$1150

Discounts	**Semester**	**Year**
Sibling Discount (if your sibling previously participated in an NWSE exchange program)	$125	$175
Early Bird Discount (if you apply before the Early Bird Deadline below; One-Way programs only)	$150	$150

Deadlines

You must submit all application materials before the Early Bird Deadline to receive the discount. NWSE will consider late applications (submitted after the Late Deadline) on a space-available basis, and a non-refundable late fee of $300 will be charged.

Programs	**One-Way & Reciprocal Program Deadlines**	**Direct Placement Program Deadlines**
Academic Year 2026–2027 and Fall Semester 2026	**Early Bird Deadline:** December 15, 2025 **Late Deadline:** March 9, 2026	**Deadline:** May 31, 2026
Spring Semester 2027	**Early Bird Deadline:** March 1, 2026 **Late Deadline:** June 1, 2026	**Deadline:** October 15, 2026

NOTE: NWSE confirms placements of accepted applicants upon securing school acceptance and completing the school and host family vetting processes. While most One-Way applicants will be notified of their host families before July 2026, **some host family placements will be finalized as late as August 31, 2026.** For spring semester 2027 applicants, placements may occur as late as January 15, 2027. Reciprocal placements are limited and subject to the availability of American applicants.